

Message from the Commissioner

Innovation is the primary driving force for development, and protecting IPR is equal to protecting innovation. In 2023, the Chinese government significantly optimized the administrative mechanism for IPR to steer the development in the IP area towards new leap forwards and enhancements. CNIPA was adjusted into an institution directly under the State Council, an inter-ministerial joint conference system was established to boost the competitiveness of China in the area of intellectual property, and a series of major policy documents were issued and implemented, such as the *Reform Plan for the Division of Financial Powers and Expenditure Responsibilities Between Central and Local Governments in the Field of Intellectual Property Rights* and the *Special Action Plan for Patent Transformation and Utilization (2023-2025)*. In the *Global Innovation Index 2023* published by the World Intellectual Property Organization (WIPO), China became the nation with the most "top 100 science and technology clusters" for the first time.

CNIPA further improved the quality of IP examination and made efforts to provide more convenient and efficient services. The total number of valid domestic invention patents in China reached 4.015 million, and China became the world's first country with more than 4 million valid domestic invention patents. The number of applications from China for PCT international patents, Hague international designs, and Madrid international trademarks steadily ranked at the forefront of the world. The average pendency for the examination of invention patents was reduced to 16 months, and the average pendency for the trademark examination was reduced to

4 months, both reaching the international advanced level with comparable examination systems. The coverage of IP public service branch centers and comprehensive service institutions was further expanded, and the basic IP data became readily accessible to the public.



CNIPA continued to strengthen the protection of IPR to help build a first-class business environment.

The newly amended *Implementing Regulations of the Patent Law* came into force, new amendments to the *Trademark Law* and its *Implementing Regulations* were speeded up, the *Measures for the Protection of Products with Geographical Indications* and the *Provisions on Registration and Management of Collective Marks and Certification Marks* were issued, the pilot projects for IPR protection of data were further promoted, and the construction of national IP protection demonstration zones was carried out at a high standard, with 112 national IP protection centers and fast-track IPR enforcement centers built. The social satisfaction rating on IP protection reached 82.04, hitting a new record high.

CNIPA continued to promote the commercialization and utilization of IP to effectively empower the innovative development of the economy. The *Special Action for Patent Transformation and Utilization* was further implemented to promote the commercialization



of new scientific research outcomes into practical productivity. The patent and trademark pledge financing amounted to 853.99 billion RMB in 2023, a year-on-year increase of 75.4%, benefiting 37 thousand enterprises. The total imports and exports of IPR royalties reached 376.52 billion RMB. The added value of patent-intensive industries in China reached 15.3 trillion RMB, accounting for 12.7% of GDP, and contributing 1/8 of GDP nationwide with less than 7% of the total employment of the society. The patent industrialization rate in enterprises exceeded 50% for the first time.

CNIPA continued to advance international cooperation on IP to promote the open circulation of innovation resources. CNIPA deepened the

engagement in global IP governance under the framework of WIPO, and held a series of high-level activities marking the 50th anniversary of cooperation between China and WIPO. Three cooperation achievements were included in the list of deliverables of the 3rd Belt and Road Forum for International Cooperation. CNIPA actively participated in the IP5 cooperation, deepened and expanded the BRICS cooperation on IP, and held the China-Central Asia, China-ASEAN and China-Africa IP cooperation conferences. The second list of 350 GI products to be recognized and protected by China and the EU was publicized.

The year 2024 marks the 75th anniversary of the People's Republic of China. It is also a crucial year for implementing *the Outline for Boosting China's Competitiveness in the Area of Intellectual Property* and the 14th Five-Year Plan. CNIPA will comprehensively strengthen the chain of IP creation, utilization, protection, management and service, and further deepen the friendly cooperation with IP offices of other countries and regions worldwide to jointly promote a fairer and more equitable global IP governance system, to build a more dynamic global IP ecosystem, and to create a brighter future.

Shen Changyu
Commissioner

China National Intellectual Property Administration